THE SET SQUARE

Norma

SIZE RANKING 74

BRIGHTEST STAR Gamma-2 (γ^2) 4.0

GENITIVE Normae

ABBREVIATION Nor

HIGHEST IN SKY AT 10 PM June

FULLY VISIBLE 29°N–90°S

Norma was introduced in the 1750s by the Frenchman Nicolas Louis de Lacaille (see p.422) and was originally known as *Norma et Regula*, the square and ruler. It is an unremarkable southern constellation lying in the Milky Way between Lupus and the zodiacal constellation of Scorpius.

The stars that Lacaille designated Alpha (α) and Beta (β) have since been incorporated into Scorpius.

SPECIFIC FEATURES

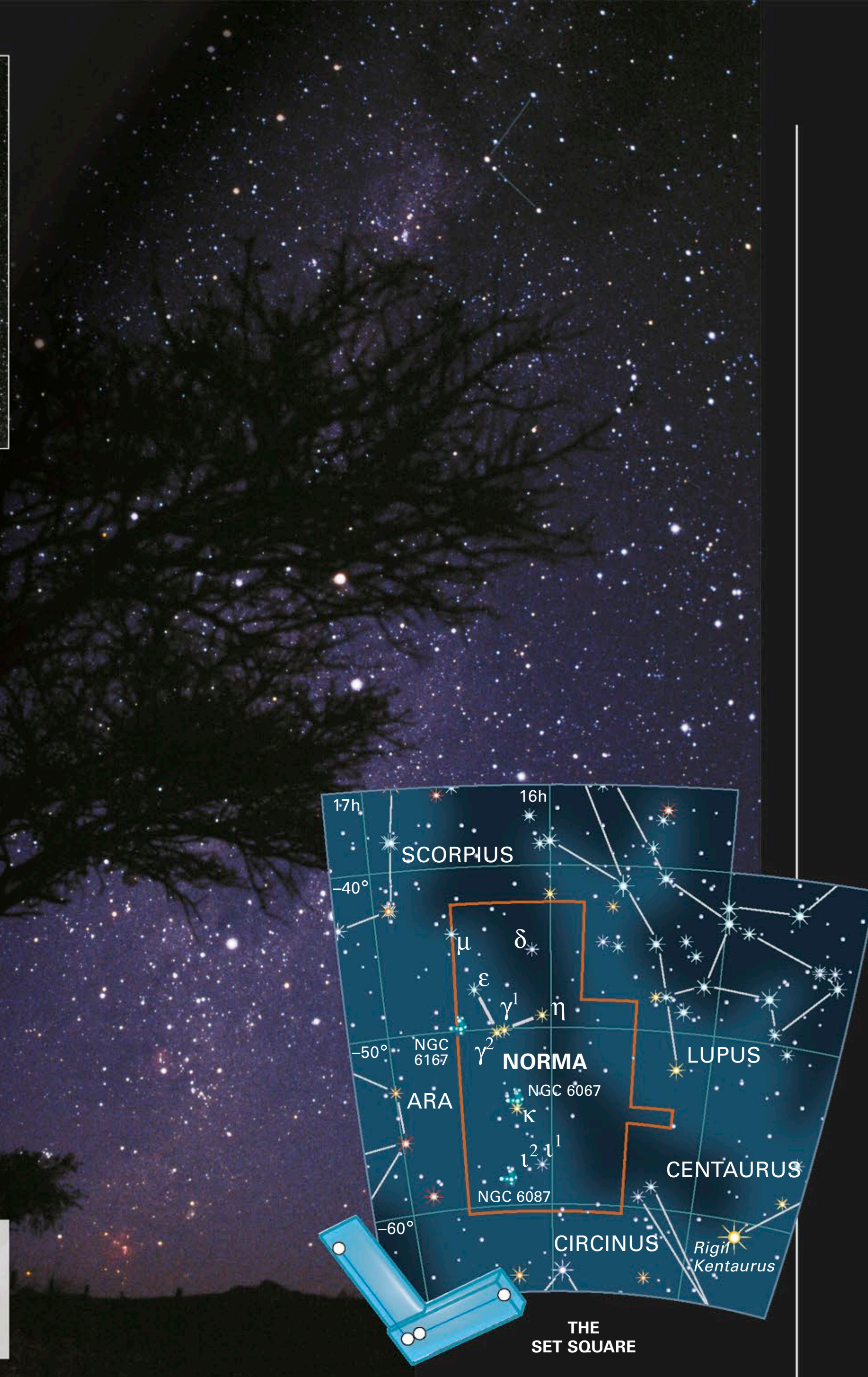
At magnitude 4.0, Gamma-2 (γ^2) Normae is the constellation's brightest star, and it is one-half of a naked-eye double together with Gamma-1 (γ^1) Normae, of magnitude 5.0. The two stars lie at widely different distances and hence are unrelated.

Two other doubles in the constellation that are readily separated through a small telescope are Epsilon (ε) Normae, with components of 5th and 7th magnitudes, and Iota-1 (ι^1) Normae, with components of 5th and 8th magnitudes.

NGC 6087 is a large open cluster that has radiating chains of stars, which are visible through binoculars. Near its center is its brightest star, S-Normae—a Cepheid variable that ranges in brightness from magnitude 6.1 to 6.8 every 9.8 days.

NGC 6067
This rich cluster covers an area of sky about half the apparent diameter of a full moon. It is seen against the backdrop of the Milky Way.

RIGHT ANGLE
Norma's most distinctive feature is a right-angled trio of three faint stars, which is somewhat difficult to identify among the rich Milky Way star fields.



THE SET SQUARE

THE SOUTHERN TRIANGLE

Triangulum Australe

SIZE RANKING 83

BRIGHTEST STAR Alpha (α) 1.9

GENITIVE Trianguli Australis

ABBREVIATION TrA

HIGHEST IN SKY AT 10 PM June–July

FULLY VISIBLE 19°N–90°S

Triangulum Australe is one of the constellations of the southern sky that was introduced at the end of the 16th century by the Dutch navigators Pieter Dirkszoon Keyser and Frederick de Houtman. It is the smallest of the 12 they identified.

Although smaller than its northern counterpart, Triangulum, this constellation contains brighter stars and so is more prominent.

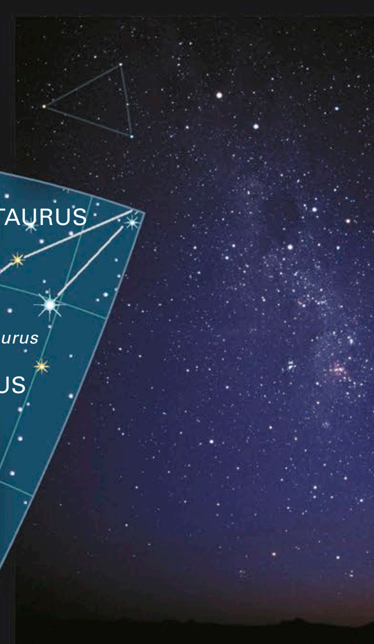
SPECIFIC FEATURES

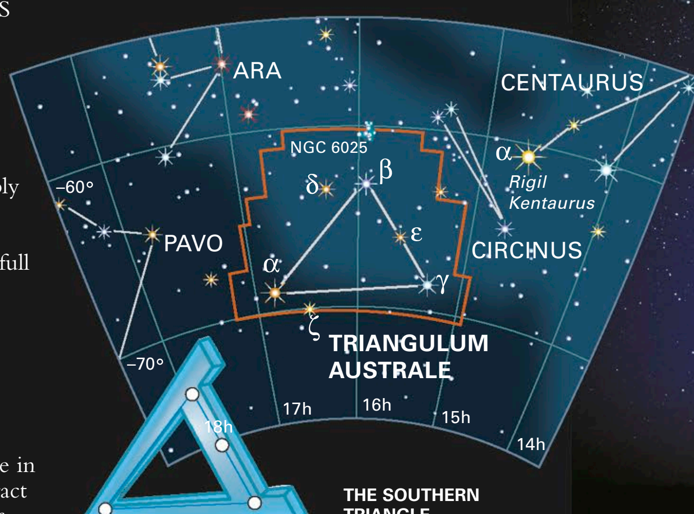
NGC 6025 lies on Triangulum Australe's northern border with Norma. It is 2,700 light-years away from Earth. This open cluster is noticeably elongated in shape and is about one-third the apparent diameter of a full moon. It is easily seen through binoculars.

Alpha (α) Trianguli Australis is an orange giant whose color shows prominently through binoculars.

There is nothing else in the constellation to attract users of small telescopes.

SOUTHERN TRIPLET
Triangulum Australe is an easily recognized triangle of stars, lying in the Milky Way near brilliant Alpha (α) and Beta (β) Centauri, which here are visible on the right.





THE SOUTHERN TRIANGLE